

Pros: Free, basic. Manually enter all your spending into customized categories so you have to confront what you're spending. It has no frills, and the emphasis is on a balance between income and spending.

Cons: Some features cost money. Founded by Dave Ramsey so some of the products pushed on you are Ramsey specific. It's time-consuming to input every expense by hand because you have to enter everything down to the, you guessed it, dollar.

CLARITY MONEY

Pros: It can help you cancel unwanted accounts or unused memberships, provides discounts and coupons, can reach out to providers and negotiate to lower your bills, helps you save for big-ticket specific items, and provides your credit score. It also has cool pie charts.

Cons: Takes a one-third commission for any negotiating on your behalf. It works best if you have a steady income you can input (no freelancing) and is better for monitoring spending habits than for budgeting.

EXCEL

Pros: Old faithful. Excel is REALLY no frills; it's just a spreadsheet service that comes with your computer. Before all these apps, many people used it to keep track of their finances without all those annoying bells and whistles.

Cons: All manual, baby.

